GUJARATI COLLECTION

NO. 04



GUJARAT ORIGIN

Ringan Batata Nu Shaak

Eggplant & Potato Curry
with Peanut-Sesame Masala

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

Ringan Batata Nu Shaak

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DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Everyday Pairing of Gujarati Kitchens

Ringan batata nu shaak — eggplant and potato cooked together in a peanut and sesame spiced masala — is one of the most fundamental combinations in everyday Gujarati home cooking, the kind of dish that appears on family tables with such regularity that it rarely gets special mention, simply expected as part of the regular rotation of shaak (vegetable curries) that accompany rice, roti, and dal at nearly every meal.

What distinguishes this shaak from similar eggplant-potato preparations found elsewhere in India is its distinctive masala, built from ground peanuts and sesame seeds alongside the more common coriander and cumin — a combination that adds richness and a subtle nuttiness without relying on cream, cashews, or other more expensive thickeners, reflecting Gujarati cooking's broader tendency toward resourceful, plant-based richness.

Like much of everyday Gujarati cooking, this dish carries a characteristic touch of sweetness alongside its savory spicing, a small amount of sugar or jaggery working alongside the peanuts to round out the dish's overall flavor — a subtle reminder, even in the most humble daily cooking, of Gujarati cuisine's distinctive sweet-savory sensibility.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Everyday Pairing of Gujarati Kitchens, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

One of the most common everyday shaak (vegetable curry) combinations in Gujarati home kitchens, appearing regularly without special occasion. Distinguished by its peanut-sesame masala, a distinctive Gujarati approach to building richness without cream or cashews. Reflects Gujarati cuisine's characteristic touch of sweetness even in humble, daily cooking. A dish that exemplifies the unglamorous but essential backbone of everyday Gujarati thali meals.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

15m	25m	4	Easy
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME	SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Small dry pan, for roasting peanuts and sesame seeds
- Spice grinder or mortar and pestle
- Kadai or wide pan

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Ringan batata nu shaak keeps refrigerated for up to 3 days and reheats well. It freezes reasonably well for up to a month, though eggplant's texture softens somewhat — still enjoyable for casual meals.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the dish

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Small eggplants, quartered	4	300 g	4
Potatoes, cubed	2 medium	250 g	2 medium
Peanuts, roasted	3 tbsp	30 g	3 chammach
Sesame seeds	2 tbsp	20 g	2 chammach
Coriander powder	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Cumin powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Turmeric powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Red chili powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Oil	3 tbsp	45 ml	3 chammach
Mustard seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Cumin seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Asafoetida (hing)	pinch	pinch	chutki bhar
Sugar	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Water	¼ cup	60 ml	¼ katori
Salt	1 tsp	6 g	to taste
Fresh coriander, chopped, for garnish	2 tbsp	8 g	2 tbsp

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

This dish uses only widely available pantry staples and produce, making it one of the most globally accessible recipes in the collection. Any small eggplant variety works, though Indian baby eggplants, if available at South Asian grocers, hold their shape particularly well in this preparation. Peanuts and sesame seeds are both easy to find at any general grocery store.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Peanut-Sesame Masala

01 ROAST THE PEANUTS AND SESAME SEEDS

Dry roast the peanuts and sesame seeds separately in a small pan until fragrant and lightly golden, being careful not to burn the sesame seeds, which toast quickly.

02 GRIND TO A COARSE POWDER

Once cooled, grind the roasted peanuts and sesame seeds together to a coarse, slightly textured powder — not a smooth paste.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Peanut-Sesame Masala, continued



Chef tip. a coarse grind, rather than a fine powder, gives the finished dish a pleasant textural bite.

COOKING CHECKPOINT

The peanut-sesame mixture should be coarsely ground with visible texture, not a smooth paste — this texture carries through into the finished dish.

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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Cooking the Vegetables

03 TEMPER THE SPICES

Heat oil in a kadai and add mustard seeds, letting them pop. Add cumin seeds and asafoetida, letting them sizzle.

04 ADD THE VEGETABLES

Add the cubed potato and quartered eggplant, along with turmeric, coriander powder, cumin powder, and chili powder, stirring to coat evenly.



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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Cooking the Vegetables, continued

05 COOK COVERED

Add the water and salt, cover, and cook on medium-low heat for 15–18 minutes, stirring gently every few minutes, until the vegetables are tender.

06 ADD THE PEANUT-SESAME POWDER

Stir in the roasted peanut-sesame powder and sugar, mixing gently to coat the vegetables evenly. Cook uncovered for a final 3–4 minutes to let the flavors meld.

Texture indicator. the finished shaak should be a semi-dry curry, with the vegetables coated in a textured, nutty masala rather than swimming in liquid.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Stirring too vigorously once the eggplant has softened breaks it apart into a mush. Stir gently, especially in the later stages of cooking.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served as part of a Gujarati thali alongside dal, rice, and roti.
- A common everyday lunch or dinner vegetable dish in Gujarati households.

Family Style

- A simple, dependable side dish rounding out a home-cooked meal without much fuss.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Modern Pairing

- Works well as a flavorful, plant-based side alongside any grain or bread.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Texture Right

- A coarse, not smooth, grind of the peanut-sesame mixture is what gives this dish its distinctive texture.
- Cooking covered for most of the process helps the vegetables soften evenly without needing excessive stirring.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- The peanut-sesame powder can be made in a larger batch and stored, ready to use for future preparations of this dish.
- This shaak reheats well, making it practical for meal prep across a busy week.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some cooks add a small amount of tamarind or lemon juice for extra tang, balancing the dish's inherent nuttiness and sweetness with a touch of sourness.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

195 kcal	5 g	20 g	11 g	5 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with oil and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Gluten, Peanuts, Mustard, Sesame. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Ringan Batata with Tomato	some households add chopped tomato for extra moisture and tang.
Dry Ringan Batata	a drier version with less water, cooked down further for a more concentrated flavor.
Ringan Batata with Green Peas	a heartier variation adding fresh or frozen green peas.

Can I use regular eggplant instead of small varieties?

Yes — cut a larger eggplant into similar-sized cubes; the cooking time may need slight adjustment.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Why did my eggplant turn mushy?

Likely overcooked or stirred too vigorously. Cook just until tender and handle gently, especially once the eggplant has softened.

Is this dish very spicy?

No — it's mild to moderately spiced, with more emphasis on the nutty peanut-sesame flavor than chili heat.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Ringan	Gujarati for eggplant, one of the two main vegetables in this dish.
Batata	Gujarati for potato, the second main vegetable in this dish.
Shaak	Gujarati for a vegetable curry or side dish.
Til	Gujarati for sesame seeds, a key part of this dish's distinctive masala.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Ringan Batata Nu Shaak

15m	25m
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME
4	**Easy**
SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

DISH

Small eggplants	300 g
Potatoes	250 g
Peanuts	30 g
Sesame seeds	20 g
Coriander powder	3 g
Cumin powder	1.5 g
Turmeric powder	1.5 g
Red chili powder	1.5 g
Oil	45 ml
Mustard seeds	4 g
Cumin seeds	4 g
Asafoetida	pinch
Sugar	4 g
Water	60 ml
Salt	6 g
Fresh coriander	8 g

METHOD

01 **Roast the peanuts and sesame seeds.** Dry roast the peanuts and sesame seeds separately in a small pan until fragrant and lightly golden, being careful not to burn the sesame seeds, which toast quickly.

02 **Grind to a coarse powder.** Once cooled, grind the roasted peanuts and sesame seeds together to a coarse, slightly textured powder — not a smooth paste.

03 **Temper the spices.** Heat oil in a kadai and add mustard seeds, letting them pop.

04 **Add the vegetables.** Add the cubed potato and quartered eggplant, along with turmeric, coriander powder, cumin powder, and chili powder, stirring to coat evenly.

05 **Cook covered.** Add the water and salt, cover, and cook on medium-low heat for 15–18 minutes, stirring gently every few minutes, until the vegetables are tender.

06 **Add the peanut-sesame powder.** Stir in the roasted peanut-sesame powder and sugar, mixing gently to coat the vegetables evenly.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐	Small eggplants	300 g	
☐	Peanuts	30 g	
☐	Coriander powder	3 g	
☐	Turmeric powder	1.5 g	
☐	Oil	45 ml	
☐	Cumin seeds	4 g	
☐	Sugar	4 g	
☐	Fresh coriander	8 g	
☐	Potatoes	250 g	
☐	Sesame seeds	20 g	
☐	Cumin powder	1.5 g	
☐	Red chili powder	1.5 g	
☐	Mustard seeds	4 g	
☐	Asafoetida	pinch	
☐	Salt	6 g	

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